

Web Portal and Integrated Web-Based Information System

Department of Christian Religious Affairs

1. Introduction

The Department of Christian Religious Affairs proposes the development of an **Official Website** integrated with several **Web-Based Information Systems** to enhance public service delivery, transparency, record management, and administrative efficiency.

The proposed platform will function as:

- **An official public information portal**
 - **A secure internal system** for managing departmental processes
 - **A centralized digital repository** for registrations, certifications, renovation records, and administrative reports
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2. Objectives of the System

The main objectives of the proposed system are to:

- Provide accurate and up-to-date information to the public
 - Digitize and centralize departmental records
 - Improve service efficiency, transparency, and accountability
 - Ensure secure handling of sensitive data
 - Reduce paperwork and manual duplication
 - Enable reliable reporting and monitoring
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3. General Department Website (Public Portal)

This platform will serve as the official public-facing website of the Department.

Main Sections (www.christian.gov.lk)

- Home
- Church Details (Catholic / Christian)
- About Us
- Latest News & Announcements Section (This will update regularly)
- Downloads (Forms, Circulars, Guidelines)
- Pasam Lathoni
- Gallery (This will update regularly)
- Contact Us

Key Features

- Mobile-friendly, responsive design
 - Fast loading and optimized performance
 - Multi-language support (Sinhala, Tamil, English)
 - Public access to selected approved information
 - User-friendly navigation suitable for all age groups
 - User Friendly Backend for the website
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4. Integrated Web-Based Information Systems

The main website will be integrated with several secure internal systems to manage departmental services.

4.1 Church Registration Management System

This system will digitalize the registration process for Catholic and Christian churches. The department already maintains an Access database for registrations, and all information will be retrieved from this database.

Current Manual Process

- Physical applications submitted to the Department
- Manual review and approval by authorized officers
- Forwarding to the Ministry of Buddhasasana for review
- Forwarding to the Ministry of Defense (MOD) for clearance
- Final approval issued by the Ministry
- Officers manually enter application details into the MS Access database
- Status updates maintained manually
- Certificates issued manually
- Manual generation of official reports

Web-Based System Improvements

- Fully web-based application management
 - Automated SMS and Email Notifications of Application Status
 - Automatic publication of approved church details on the public website (with limited data)
 - Centralized reporting and searchable records
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4.2 Priesthood Identity / Passport Certification System

This system will digitalize the issuance of Priesthood certification to Fathers and Sisters for Identity and Passport. The department already maintains an Access database for this, and all information will be retrieved from this database.

Scope

- Recording physical applications
 - Manual review and approval workflow
 - System-generated official certification letters
 - Digital archival of issued letters
 - Automated report generation
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4.3 Visa Recommendation Letter Management System

This module manages three types of Visa-related recommendation letters:

- Entry Visa
- Resident Visa
- Visa Extension

The department already maintains an Access database for this, and all information will be retrieved from this database.

Current Manual Process

(Identical to church registration manual workflow)

- Physical applications received
- Review and approval at Department
- Ministry of Buddhasasana review
- Ministry of Defence (MOD) review
- Final approval by the Ministry
- Manual data entry into MS Access
- Manual updates and certificate issuance
- Manual report preparation

Web-Based System Key Functions

- Tracking applications through all approval stages
 - Updating clearance and approval status
 - Generating official recommendation letters
 - Automated SMS and email notifications
 - Generation of statistical and administrative reports
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4.4 Church Renovation Information System

This system replaces the Excel-based process currently used to manage church renovations.

Scope

- Recording renovation request letters
 - Updating renovation details after approval
 - Uploading photographs (before and after renovation)
 - Publishing selected approved renovation details on the public portal
 - Generating monitoring and progress reports
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4.5 Free of Charge Medical Letter Issuing System

This is not a separate module, this system get the information from existing Visa Recommendation (database) System.

Scope

- Retrieving applicant details using the passport number
 - Issuing free-of-charge medical letters
 - Printing system-generated letters
 - Producing related administrative reports
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4.6. Thalawila Pilgrim House Online Booking System

The current manual booking system will be replaced by an automated online reservation module with online payment.

Objectives

- Automate the reservation process
- Reduce manual workload and booking errors
- Provide a user-friendly booking experience
- Maintain accurate real-time availability and occupancy records

Scope & Features

- Online booking portal via the departmental website
- Real-time display of available rooms
- Online submission of booking requests
- Automated SMS and email notifications (confirmation, reminders, cancellations)
- Administrative dashboard for staff
- Approve, modify, or cancel reservations
- Detailed booking and occupancy reports
- Secure digital storage of reservation history

Internal Workflow

1. Pilgrim submits online booking request
 2. System notifies responsible officers
 3. Officer reviews and approves/declines the booking
 4. System issues automated confirmation
 5. Centralized database is updated
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6. Target Users

The system will serve:

- General Catholic and Christian public
 - Clergy (Fathers and Sisters)
 - Department Officers and Administrative Staff
 - Department Heads and Supervisory Officials
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7. Non-Functional Requirements

The system shall ensure:

- Government-level security compliance
 - Controlled access for authorized internal users
 - Reliable data storage and backup mechanisms
 - Fast, responsive mobile-friendly design
 - Accuracy and consistency of information
 - High availability and stability
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8. Data Security and Reliability

- Secure access using role-based authentication
- Logging and audit trails
- Protection of sensitive religious and personal data
- Reliable backup and disaster recovery procedures
- Controlled internal access to confidential data